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Guide 2, 15 minutes, 4 steps

Which model for which process

A map from everyday business tasks
to the smallest model that does them.
This PDF is the printed version of an interactive guide. To run the experiments yourself: **halilneed.agency/guides/model-map/**

Step 1 of 4

Rules or a model?

The task: spot refund requests. Add words to the rule and see what it misses.

The rule's keywords

+ return + money + back + refund

5 / 8	7 / 8
Rule correct	Model correct

I want to return my order	✓ Rule	✓ Model
Can I get my money back?	✓ Rule	✓ Model
The item arrived broken, I want a refund	✓ Rule	✗ Model
These shoes don't fit, what can I do?	✗ Rule	✓ Model
I read your return policy, thanks	✗ Rule	✓ Model
Where is my parcel?	✓ Rule	✓ Model
I'd like to change my billing address	✓ Rule	✓ Model
Is there a money-saving bundle?	✗ Rule	✓ Model

The model column is illustrative: what a small classifier trained on examples typically does.

Every new word catches something and brings a false alarm. A model learns from examples, and it is sometimes wrong too.

Step 2 of 4

Six kinds of model

Tap a kind: what goes in, what comes out, where it works.

Classifier

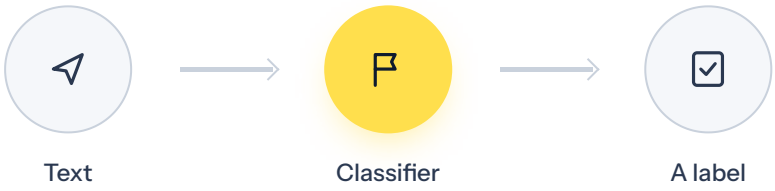
Extractor

Generator

Search

Forecast

Anomaly



Example: Sending an email to the right team.
Needs: Dozens of examples per label.

⚠ Most business steps need a model far smaller than a chat model.

Step 3 of 4

Four questions that choose

Answer in order. The first “yes” picks the kind.

Is the output one of a fixed list of labels?	**Yes**	No
Is the output pieces taken from the text?	Yes	No
Is the output the best matches among existing documents?	Yes	No
Is the output a number, or an unusual case?	Yes	No

Classifier

Extractor

Generator

Search

Forecast

Anomaly

✓ Classifier

⚠ If every answer is “no”, you need a generative model. It is the most flexible and the most expensive option.

Step 4 of 4

Where each department starts

Pick your department and see where to begin.

Sales	
→ Ranking incoming leads by priority	Classifier
→ Product and quantity from a quote email	Extractor
→ Forecasting monthly sales	Forecast
Customer service	
→ Routing a request to the right team	Classifier
→ Finding a similar solved request	Search
→ Summarising a long thread	Generator
Finance	
→ Fields from invoices	Extractor
→ Flagging unusual expenses	Anomaly
→ Forecasting cash flow	Forecast
HR	
→ Sorting leave requests by type	Classifier
→ Answering a staff question from the policy	Search
→ Experience and skills from a CV; people decide	Extractor
Operations	
→ Sorting fault reports by category	Classifier
→ Finding drift in sensor data	Anomaly
→ Forecasting stock needs	Forecast
Legal	
→ Dates and parties from a contract	Extractor

→	Finding a similar clause in the archive	Search
→	Drafting a clause summary	Generator
	Marketing	
→	Sorting reviews into positive and negative	Classifier
→	Drafting campaign copy	Generator
→	Forecasting campaign demand	Forecast

Try a rule first

The smallest model that does the job

Generative models last

A measure for every step

Next: personal data and AI

What to mask and what to keep in-house before text reaches a model.

halilneed.agency/guides/personal-data/

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